

Sprint Retrospective Meeting

Time 07:00 PM

Duration Approximately 45 minutes

Meeting Type Sprint Retrospective

Attendees Nasiphi Ntontela, Lungani Shezi, Mkatoko Chauke, Mutsawashe Njowa, Tendai Dhlamin, Dorsa Shahrokh

Facilitator Lungani Shezi

1. Purpose of the Meeting

The Sprint 4 retrospective was held as the final retrospective of the project. The purpose was to reflect on the team's performance during the sprint, acknowledge what went well, identify areas that presented challenges, and draw lessons that could be applied to future projects. As this was the concluding sprint, the session also served as a broader reflection on the overall project lifecycle.

2. Sprint Summary

Sprint 4 focused on finalising all outstanding user stories, resolving the Azure deployment issue, completing documentation, and preparing the application for final submission. The following items were reviewed against their completion status:

Item	Status
Receptionist role and walk-in booking logic	Completed
Admin account design and clinic authorisation	Completed
Patient-to-staff assignment on booking	Completed
Staff notes — clinical notes on patient records	Completed
Appointment notification cron job	Completed
Azure deployment	Partially resolved — deployed via personal account
Activity diagram documentation	Completed
README files on user story uploads	Completed
Multi-language support	Exploratory — not fully implemented

3. What Went Well

- The receptionist role was successfully implemented by Mkatoko within the planned sprint window, resolving a significant design challenge around walk-in booking logic.
- Collaboration between Mkatoko and Mutsawashe on the admin account scoping was effective — the pair programming approach prevented the feature from becoming blocked.

- Tendai completed the staff notes feature and appointment notification cron job with no integration issues reported.
- The team maintained consistent GitHub commit activity throughout the sprint, improving traceability and reducing merge conflict frequency compared to earlier sprints.
- The activity diagram and README documentation were completed ahead of the submission deadline without requiring last-minute effort.
- Communication in the team channel improved noticeably, with blockers being raised earlier and resolved more quickly than in previous sprints.
- The team demonstrated adaptability when the Azure student subscription continued to present constraints, pivoting to a personal account deployment to meet the submission requirement.

4. What Could Have Been Improved

- The Azure deployment issue was carried over from Sprint 3 without resolution and caused ongoing uncertainty during Sprint 4. Earlier escalation or an alternative deployment plan should have been identified sooner.
- The multi-language support feature, while a valid proposal, was introduced late in the project and could not be fully implemented without risking other deliverables. Feature scope decisions should be made at the start of a sprint rather than mid-sprint.
- The patient-to-staff assignment feature remained unallocated for an extended period before being assigned to Lungani. Future sprints should ensure all backlog items have clear ownership from the start of planning.
- Some merge conflicts in earlier sessions could have been avoided with stricter branch discipline and more frequent pull requests from shared branches.
- The daily scrum format evolved informally into technical working sessions. While this was appropriate given the project stage, it occasionally extended beyond the intended 15-minute timebox.

5. Retrospective Summary Table

What Went Well	What Could Improve	Action for Next Sprint
Receptionist role completed on time	Azure deployment blocked by student subscription limits	Identify deployment constraints at sprint start
Strong collaboration on admin account task	Multi-language feature scoped too late	Scope all features during sprint planning only
Consistent GitHub commit activity	Patient-to-staff assignment unowned for too long	All backlog items must have owners at planning
Documentation completed before deadline	Merge conflicts from uncoordinated pushes	Pull before every commit; enforce branch discipline
Improved team communication	Scrums extended into technical sessions	Separate debugging from stand-up structure

6. Individual Member Reflections

Lungani Shezi

Noted the team's growth in communication and GitHub discipline across sprints. Reflected that earlier investment in deployment infrastructure would have reduced pressure in the final sprint. Expressed satisfaction with the overall system delivered.

Nasiphi Ntontela

Highlighted the effectiveness of structured scrum meetings in keeping the team aligned. Acknowledged that the activity diagram required more time than anticipated and recommended that documentation tasks be tracked alongside development tasks from the start of each sprint.

Mkateko Chauke

Reflected positively on the collaboration with Mutsawashe during the admin account implementation. Noted that clearer API contracts between features early in the sprint would have reduced integration friction.

Mutsawashe Njowa

Appreciated the team's willingness to reassign tasks when blockers arose. Suggested that the team adopt a brief end-of-day update practice in future projects to reduce the frequency of merge conflicts.

Tendai Dhlamin

Expressed interest in continuing to explore the multi-language support feature beyond the project scope. Reflected that the cron job implementation was more straightforward than anticipated and that earlier prioritisation would have freed capacity for additional features.

Dorsa Shahrokh

Acknowledged the difficulty of the Azure deployment process and the role of the student subscription constraints in delaying progress. Recommended that teams using student accounts confirm deployment capabilities during sprint planning before committing to deployment-dependent features.

7. Overall Project Reflection

As the final sprint retrospective, the team took a moment to reflect on the project as a whole. The HealthFlow application was successfully built across four sprints, evolving from an initial authentication and dataset integration prototype into a fully featured community clinic queue management system.

Key achievements across the project included the implementation of role-based access for patients, staff, receptionists, and admins; a functional appointment booking and queue management system; deployment to Azure; and a comprehensive test suite exceeding the 60% coverage target.

The team acknowledged that earlier investment in CI/CD configuration, deployment planning, and branch management discipline would have reduced friction in later sprints. Communication and collaboration were identified as areas of consistent improvement throughout the project lifecycle.

8. Action Items

Action Item	Responsible
Submit final project deliverables and demo video	All Members
Ensure all user story README files are uploaded	All Members

Archive sprint backlog and close all completed user stories on Trello	Lungani Shezi
Share final GitHub repository link with submission	Lungani Shezi
Complete individual retrospective write-ups if required by rubric	All Members

Closing

The Sprint 4 retrospective concluded with the team expressing appreciation for each member's contributions throughout the project. Lungani thanked all members for their commitment and collaboration. The team confirmed readiness for final submission and agreed to reconvene informally following assessment results.

Meeting adjourned.